

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

03 September 2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

The financial services regulatory paralegal role at Ryder Reid Legal interests me because it sits at the intersection of regulatory work and fund-related practice, two areas I have been actively building toward through both work experience and independent study. My background in regulatory advice, document coordination and legal research at BCLP and Citizens Advice gives me a practical foundation for the research, filing coordination and client contact the role requires.

At BCLP I spent six months supporting an international arbitration team on a complex investment arbitration. I reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions, drafted procedural orders and procedural histories, and liaised directly with the client about required documents. Shortly before a major deadline I became the only junior supporting the team, which meant coordinating outstanding actions and tracking documents across multiple workstreams under real pressure. A partner and associate told me my performance at that stage was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor. That experience gave me a clear sense of what it means to manage regulatory and procedural materials carefully when the stakes are high, which is directly relevant to coordinating regulatory filing materials in this role.

At Citizens Advice I assess eligibility against statutory criteria, identify evidential gaps and draft correspondence and applications for clients in complex situations involving welfare, housing and employment law. The client contact is often with people under considerable stress, so I have had to translate detailed regulatory requirements into clear, practical guidance quickly and accurately. That combination of regulatory analysis and direct client communication maps well onto the client-facing and research responsibilities described for this role.

My interest in fund-related work developed more recently. After attending an A&O Shearman open day where a private equity session covered how different practice areas contribute to a PE transaction, I took a self-directed Coursera course on private equity covering fund structures, leverage and exit strategies. That gave me enough commercial grounding to understand the regulatory context around fund structuring, which is relevant to the fund deal aspects of this role.

I am currently completing an LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution at Queen Mary, which has sharpened my legal research skills and my ability to work with procedural and regulatory frameworks across jurisdictions. A rolling contract working closely with partners and associates in a US firm's financial services regulatory team is a clear next step from where my experience and developing interests currently sit.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva